

Springtime Storyteller

Requirements

Spring-themed video (3-5 minutes)

Device to play video (tablet, computer)

Sentence strips (optional)

Dry-erase markers (optional)

Picture cues (optional, e.g., verbs like 'hopping', 'flying')

Instructions

Introduction (5 minutes): Begin by introducing the activity. "Today, we're going to be Springtime Storytellers! We'll watch a short video about spring, and then we'll tell stories about what we see." Briefly discuss what kinds of things the patients might see in a spring video (e.g., flowers, birds, rain, animals).

Video Viewing (3-5 minutes): Play the chosen spring-themed video. Ensure all patients can see the screen clearly.

Initial Observation (2 minutes): Immediately after the video, allow a brief quiet period for the patients to process what they saw. Encourage them to think about what they want to describe.

Sentence Strip Support (10 minutes): This step is highly adaptable depending on the needs of the patients.

For patients needing significant support: Use pre-written sentence strips with a fill-in-the-blank format, focusing on subject-verb agreement. Example: "The bird is ____" or "The flowers are ____". Picture cues can be paired to help the patients select the appropriate action verb. The therapist or SLP should demonstrate first.

For patients needing some support: Provide blank sentence strips and dry-erase markers. Provide picture cues (verbs such as 'hopping', 'flying', 'blooming', 'raining') to help the patients formulate their sentences independently. Help the patients sound out the words if needed.

For patients needing minimal support: Encourage patients to formulate sentences independently without the use of the sentence strips. Picture cues can be provided as needed.

Sentence Formulation & Verbalization (8 minutes): Individually ask each patient to formulate and verbalize five complete sentences describing what they observed in the video. Provide prompts as needed to encourage sentence completion and proper subject-verb agreement (e.g., "Who is doing the action?", "What are they doing?", "Are there many or just one?"). Correct errors in a positive and supportive manner, modeling the correct sentence structure when necessary.

Example:

Patient: "Bird fly."

SLPA: "Okay, a bird. Is it one bird or many birds? Since it's one bird, we can say 'The bird *is* flying.' Can you try saying that?"

Wrap-up (2 minutes): Briefly review the activity and provide positive reinforcement for their efforts. "Great job today, Springtime Storytellers! You all worked very hard to describe what you saw."